AI Agents: Tool Use in Practice

Original practice & worked answers

10 original single-answer questions · Microsoft AI Agents · Tool Use

Choose one answer for each question. The answer section explains the reasoning and the alternatives.

01 · Which option best describes a tool in the source’s design pattern?

A. Only a sentence in the system prompt

B. A final answer already written by the model

C. Executable code such as a function or an API call

D. A replacement for all conversation messages

Original question · T-Q01 · Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 27–29

02 · In the source’s get_current_time schema, which input is required?

A. call_id as a city name

B. location as a string

C. A completed final answer

D. A database administrator password

Original question · T-Q02 · Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 84–108

03 · An agent returns a function name and location arguments for a time lookup. What should the application do next?

A. Display the function name as the current time

B. Skip execution and invent the tool result

C. Delete the conversation context

D. Execute the selected function with those arguments

Original question · T-Q03 · Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 61–173

04 · Which field links the function_call_output to its corresponding function call in the source example?

A. call_id

B. The slide number

C. The course title

D. The function description alone

Original question · T-Q04 · Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 175–180

05 · Which source use case fits an agent coordinating a scheduler and an email service in a repetitive process?

A. A standalone time lookup

B. Workflow automation

C. Function-schema naming alone

D. Conversation history storage

Original question · T-Q05 · Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 33–39

06 · Which building block validates parameters and manages unexpected tool responses?

A. Course navigation

B. Tool naming alone

C. Error handling and validation

D. The lesson’s video thumbnail

Original question · T-Q06 · Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 53–53

07 · What does the MCP server provide for the framework to load?

A. Tools together with their schemas

B. Only a final response for every possible request

C. A guarantee that every query remains local

D. A replacement for the model’s task selection

Original question · T-Q07 · Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 241–245

08 · Which pairing matches the source’s managed-service tool categories?

A. Code Interpreter = knowledge; File Search = action

B. Every tool belongs only to a thread

C. Function Calling = knowledge; search = action

D. File Search = knowledge; Code Interpreter = action

Original question · T-Q08 · Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 278–289

09 · Which statement correctly distinguishes a toolset from a thread?

A. A thread groups tools; a toolset stores messages

B. A toolset groups tools; a thread retains conversation history

C. Both mean the final model answer

D. Neither is used by the source’s service example

Original question · T-Q09 · Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 291–291

10 · An agent is intended to answer questions by reading a database. Which access arrangement follows the lesson’s recommendation?

A. Give it permission to drop tables so every request succeeds

B. Use unrestricted database administration access

C. Assign restricted read-only access, such as a SELECT role

D. Rely on the tool’s name instead of database permissions

Original question · T-Q10 · Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 329–333

Answers & reasoning

01 · Answer C

A tool is code that can be executed to perform actions, including simple functions and external API calls.

• Identify the executable capability.

A: A description can explain a tool, but it is not the executable capability.
B: A final answer is distinct from the tool.
C: This matches the source definition.
D: The pattern still needs message handling.
Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 27–29

02 · Answer B

The source's function schema defines location as a string and lists it as required.

• Read the parameters and required list.

A: call_id matches calls and results; it is not the location parameter.
B: This matches the schema.
C: The answer is produced after the tool interaction.
D: This is not a parameter of the illustrated tool.
Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 84–108

03 · Answer D

Original scenario: the returned call requests execution. The function's result must then be returned to the model.

• Distinguish a tool call from a final answer.
• Invoke the function.

A: The function name is not the requested information.
B: The source requires executing the function.
C: The example preserves messages for the next turn.
D: This is the next step in the source's loop.
Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 61–173

04 · Answer A

The returned function_call_output copies the tool call's call_id.

• Inspect the returned output message.

A: This is the matching identifier in the example.
B: Slides are not part of the source call protocol.
C: The course title is unrelated to matching.
D: The description explains the tool; it does not identify this call.
Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 175–180

05 · Answer B

Original scenario: the source describes workflow automation as integrating tools such as schedulers, email services or data pipelines.

• Identify the multi-step or repetitive process.
• Match it to the source use case.

A: This does not describe the coordinated process in the question.
B: This matches the source use case.
C: Naming alone does not carry out the process.
D: Retaining messages is a separate responsibility.
Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 33–39

06 · Answer C

The source explicitly assigns failures, parameter validation and unexpected responses to this building block.

• Identify the handling responsibility.

A: Navigation is outside the listed runtime responsibilities.
B: A name alone does not perform validation.
C: This matches the source.
D: The thumbnail is a learning resource, not runtime validation.
Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 53–53

07 · Answer A

An MCP server publishes tools and their schemas, which the framework can offer alongside local tools.

• Identify what is published.
• Separate tool availability from execution.

A: This matches the source description.
B: Published tools still need to be selected and used.
C: The source says remote-tool queries are sent to that server.
D: The agent still decides when to call available tools.
Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 241–245

08 · Answer D

File Search appears under knowledge tools; Code Interpreter appears under action tools.

• Read each source category.

A: This reverses the listed categories.
B: A thread keeps message history; it is not a category.
C: This reverses the listed categories.
D: Both entries match the source list.
Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 278–289

09 · Answer B

The source says tools can be used together as a toolset and threads track the message history of a conversation.

• Separate available capabilities from message history.

A: This reverses their roles.
B: This matches the stated roles.
C: Neither term means the final answer.
D: Both are named in the example.
Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 291–291

10 · Answer C

Original scenario: the lesson recommends read-only database configuration and a read-only SELECT role for the named database services.

• Identify the intended reading task.
• Apply the source’s restricted access recommendation.

A: Dropping tables exceeds the source’s reading boundary.
B: Unrestricted administration conflicts with the recommendation.
C: This implements the stated restricted reading access.
D: Naming is not the permission configuration described.
Source: Microsoft AI Agents for Beginners, Tool Use, lines 329–333